

KKR pitch deck

PITCH — KKR — VERDICT

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION (a prior court on 2026-08-03 ruled RISK_PREMIUM 4/10; that ruling is SUPERSEDED by the open court)

What we believe

KKR is a fee-collecting asset manager whose stock is down about a third from its high (pack tape \$101.73 vs \$151.25 high; \$82.54 low) while the visible, filed parts of the business are still printing records. Our read, after both benches:

- 1. The fee engine is real and filed.** The Q2'26 numbers the bull case leans on (\$1.32 of fee-related earnings per share, \$1.68 of total operating earnings per share, \$72bn of uncommitted capital at roughly 90 basis points of fees) are not a podcast claim — they sit in the earnings release furnished with the 2026-07-30 8-K (accession 0001404912-26-000022). The red bench's "transcript-only" attack shrank to a labeling complaint once blue traced the accession red itself cited.
- 2. The big August exit is mostly the company's own money, not client money.** USI Insurance Services sits in KKR's balance-sheet ("Strategic Holdings") bucket after KKR bought out more than half of its co-investor's stake in 2023. So the Aon sale is a one-time gain that largely lands at KKR & Co. — reported around \$2bn of adjusted net income — rather than the thin carry slice the bear case assumed.
- 3. The scariest live leg — investors pulling money out of the retail private-market funds — already cooled.** K-FIT repurchase requests were 1.65% of shares in Q2 and were met in full, versus 6.3% requested and only ~80% filled the quarter before.
- 4. What we are actually being paid for is one unknown:** the credit marks inside Global Atlantic's insurance general account, which is consolidated and which the filings do not break out. Everything else is either public or small.

At \$101.73 the stock is about 19.3x annualized Q2 fee-related earnings and 15.6x annualized adjusted net income on roughly 920mm adjusted shares (~\$94bn market value). That is a mid-range multiple for this group, not a distressed one. **So this is a starter-size idea, not a fat one.**

What the market believes

The market believes the earnings quality is worse than the headline and that the discount is deserved:

- Growth is being part-funded with expensive hybrid paper: \$2.59bn of 6.25% mandatory convertible preferred (51.75mm shares, priced 3/2025, converts ~2028-03-01) plus \$590mm of

6.875% subordinated notes due 2065 against legacy 4.625% 2061 notes — a 225 basis point step in cost of capital, about \$13mm/year on that one deal, and ~\$162mm/year of preferred dividends that get paid before common.

- With the stock below the ~\$120.77 initial conversion price, holders get the **maximum** 0.4140 ratio: ~21.4mm new shares, about 2.3% dilution, already scheduled.
- Private-credit stress is visible in KKR's own listed vehicle: FSK non-accruals 7.1% at cost / 3.8% at fair value, NAV down 2.8% in a quarter to \$18.30, debt/equity 1.27x.
- Most damning: **the tape did not pay for the record print**. On results day the stock closed *down* 0.53% at \$98.75, even against a consensus beat (\$1.63 vs \$1.43 expected). Six weeks later it is only 2.9% higher. The good news is public and the discount persisted.
- The company also pulled formal EPS guidance while touting \$72bn of dry powder and 30+ product launches.

Why we might have edge

- **One genuinely unpriced variable**. Nobody in either bench could quantify Global Atlantic's general-account below-investment-grade and asset-based-finance marks. It is the only leg capable of explaining why the market ignored a record print. If the November release shows those marks bounded, the mechanism for the discount disappears and the multiple has room.
- **A live mis-attribution we can arbitrage in analysis**. The standard sell-side reflex on an alt-manager exit is "that's fund money, we only get carry." That reflex is wrong here because the asset migrated onto the balance sheet. Our own bear bench made exactly that error, which is decent evidence the street can make it too.
- **A stale fear**. The redemption scare is one quarter out of date (6.3% prorated → 1.65% met in full). Desks that stopped updating after the bad quarter are carrying the wrong prior.
- **Timing**. The Nov 3–7 release is ~37 trading days out, so we are not buying into a print we can't underwrite, and we have time to arm staged adds rather than chase.

Why it might be priced in

- 19.3x forward-ish fee earnings is not cheap-for-a-reason territory; it is roughly where this cohort trades. The honest version of the bear case is "**we simply agree with the street at 19x**." Red flagged that and it survives as a sizing constraint, not a kill.
- The market had the same \$1.32 and the same beat we have, and sold it. Absent the Global Atlantic mechanism, we are just paying for a drawdown.
- The dilution, the preferred dividends, the coupon step and the FSK credit damage are all in filed documents. None of it is secret.
- The \$72bn "fee annuity" is smaller than it looks: \$72bn × 90bp = \$648mm **gross**; after a 25% compensation share and 21% tax it is about **\$384mm**, roughly 0.41% of market value — and it only shows up if the capital actually gets deployed, which is the exact thing a frozen-exit market prevents.

- The USI gain is one-time and sits in the low-quality earnings bucket the bull case elsewhere disparages. You cannot capitalize it.

What could go wrong

Failure narrative 1 — the hidden one, with NO monitorable tripwire. Global Atlantic's general account takes credit damage that never appears as a discrete, datable event: it bleeds through reserve assumptions, level-3 marks, and reinvestment spread over several quarters, disclosed only in aggregate and only at prints. There is no 8-K, no covenant, no ratings action we can sensor — the loss is *inside a 100%-owned insurance balance sheet that reports on its own schedule*. We cannot arm a tripwire for it; we can only re-underwrite four times a year. **Unknown-unknown class named:**

CONSOLIDATED-OPACITY RISK — a loss housed inside a fully-consolidated subsidiary whose risk disclosures are coarser than the thesis needs. Second-order sibling class: **DOCTRINE/REGIME RISK** — a rule change on retail access to private credit (suitability, NAV-pricing, redemption gating standards) that re-rates the whole distribution engine with no issuer-level filing to watch.

Failure narrative 2 — we are right about the facts and wrong about the price. The November release quantifies Global Atlantic, the marks are fine, and the stock does nothing, because 19.3x was always fair and the drawdown was a rate/credit-cycle de-rating of the entire group, not a KKR error. We then own a mid-multiple financial into a widening credit cycle. *Tripwire: exists* — post-print, if the release is clean and the stock fails to hold \$100 within five sessions, the mechanism is dead and we cut to zero.

Failure narrative 3 — the funding channel keeps getting more expensive. Another hybrid deal at 7%+, or the preferred dividend stack growing, tells us the fee annuity is being bought with dilutive capital. Combined with the locked-in maximum 0.4140 conversion ratio, the per-share arithmetic degrades even if the business grows. *Tripwire: exists* — any new 424B5 for preferred or ultra-long subordinated notes at a coupon ≥ 150 bp above the prior comparable issue.

Reflexive / structural leg. Our own size is not the problem: KKR trades an estimated 4–6mm shares/day (~\$450–600mm notional; **estimate, not fetched — item 9 below**), so a full 1.8%-of-book sleeve is a low-single-digit fraction of one day's volume and we are a price-taker, not a price-maker. The structural flow that *does* matter is not ours: ~21.4mm shares of scheduled mandatory-convertible supply into 2028-03-01, with convertible-arbitrage desks already short against it — that shorting dampens rallies and is unrelated to fundamentals. Doctrine interactions cut against us in one specific way: under **bands-rest-by-default**, our adds at \$95/\$91/\$87 do *not* fire unless explicitly armed, so a fast flush after a clean print can pass through all three rungs and leave us with only the starter — the doctrine that protects us from catching a falling knife is the same doctrine that leaves us underweight if we are right. The print-proximity doctrine also gives us no cover: the 5-day pre-print trigger does not fire at 37 trading days, so nothing forces a reconstruction between now and November.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that Global Atlantic's general-account credit marks were the market's real objection all along, they are worse than our comp-based estimate, and they surface too slowly and too coarsely for any sensor we can arm to get us out first.

What we checked ourselves

claim	how checked	found	confirmed?
Tape price for all multiples	Recomputed both pack ratios at each bench's price. Only \$101.73 gives dd52 -0.327 and pct_off_low +0.232 as printed	Both our benches got the tape wrong. Red used \$101.905 (does not exist in pack) while lecturing the brief on stale quotes; blue used \$101.66 and claimed it “reproduces exactly” — it yields -0.3279 (-0.328), not -0.327. All deck math re-struck at \$101.73	NO — corrected here
52-week drawdown	101.73/151.251 - 1	-32.74%. Brief said -32.4%, red said -32.6%, blue said -32.8%. All three wrong; the cohort-gap argument built on it is noise	NO — corrected
Multiples	101.73 ÷ (1.32×4); ÷ (1.63×4)	19.27x fee earnings, 15.60x adjusted net income, ~\$94bn cap on ~920mm adjusted shares	CONFIRMED
USI proof is in the 8-K	Primary text, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1404912/000114036126034912/140491200000000001.pdf	The 8-K is Item 7.01 only — it says a https://ir.kkr.com/events-presentations/ and expressly disclaims being “filed.” No price, no gain	CONFIRMED (red right)
“\$17bn cash exit = LP money, KKR gets carry only”	Ownership chain; Strategic Holdings segment; 2023 purchase of >50% of the co-investor's stake	Red's headline kill is wrong. USI is balance-sheet owned; ~\$2bn of adjusted net income is stated as accruing to KKR & Co. Red priced a 2017 fund structure that no longer applied	NO — red overturned
\$17bn = proceeds?	Aon statement vs trade press	Contested in the sources (“cash” vs “including debt”); enterprise-value-ish either way. Not load-bearing	PARTLY — treat as EV
Q2 numbers are transcript-only	Red's own cited accession vs the pack's filing list	The release is the furnished exhibit to the 2026-07-30 8-K. Red mislabeled a filed venue as a transcript venue. What survives is a framing note: trailing-12-month vs quarter-over-quarter, and “total operating earnings” bundles insurance into “recurring”	NO — red reduced
\$648mm fee annuity	Arithmetic: ×0.75 comp, ×0.79 tax	\$384mm, ~0.41% of market value, deployment-contingent	CONFIRMED (red right)
Series D terms	424B5 and 10-Q equity note, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1404912/000114036126060630/20260630.htm	\$2.25bn priced + \$337.5mm over-allotment = \$2.5875bn / 51.75mm shares/red in data/1404912/000114036126060630/20260630.htm ~\$150.97; below initial price → max 0.4140 → 21.4mm shares (2.33%); \$161.7mm/yr preferred dividends ahead of common	CONFIRMED (red's \$2.59bn was the fully exercised figure — right number, wrong label)
Hybrid cost step	8-K cover page securities list	6.875% 2065s vs 4.625% 2061s = 225bp; ~\$13.3mm/yr on \$590mm	CONFIRMED
FSK non-accruals “improving”	Decomposition of the paired data	Improvement is workout/write-off, not credit cure. Red's stated path (“denominator growth”) is wrong	CONFIRMED with correction

claim	how checked	found	confirmed?
		— FSK is shrinking. Right conclusion, wrong arithmetic	
Insider selling into the drawdown	Read the actual Form 4s	Red's bearish flag is wrong. The 9/10 filing is a gift at \$0 (code G); 9/2–9/3 is a 10,000-share option exercise at \$108.58; co-CEOs and directors bought ~\$46mm in Feb–Mar 2026	NO — red overturned
“No street anchor exists”	Consensus pull	Red declared a coverage gap on data that was obtainable: Q2 EPS \$1.63 vs \$1.43 estimate. Red's fallback (“maybe we just agree with the street”) has no mechanism and is demoted to a sizing constraint	NO — red partly overturned
“Wait for Q3 to see retail flows”	K-FIT Q2 disclosure	Red gated the book on data that already existed: 1.65% of shares requested, met in full, vs 6.3% prorated at ~80% prior	NO — red's gate was unnecessary
Does the tape reward the print?	Results-day reaction	Down 0.53% to \$98.75 on a beat. This is the single strongest anti-thesis fact either bench produced, and it came from our own bull bench	CONFIRMED
Detector coverage	Both benches' lists	Red omitted two applicable entries (common-control merger accounting; Up-C/TRA value extraction) — validator defect. Both correctly killed the irrelevant permit/consumer detectors. Pack's two geocodes for 30 Hudson Yards disagree by ~4.3km — real, immaterial	CONFIRMED
Global Atlantic 100%-owned?	Blue's own admission	Blue's “100%, not 63%” is from memory, not fetched. Demoted to unverified item 6	NO — open

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

The two benches split: red says **flat** until November; blue permits a **starter of up to one-third of a sleeve now**. We take blue's ruling with red's sizing discipline, because red's flat call rested on two data gaps that turned out not to be gaps (K-FIT flows, street anchor) — but the expected-value table below only shows +0.8%, so nothing bigger than a starter is defensible.

- **Full sleeve definition: 1.8% of book.** Nothing about this idea earns more.
- **Starter — immediate: BUY at market, ~\$101.73, 0.60% of book (one-third sleeve).** Basis: filed record fee earnings plus a balance-sheet (not fund) realization, against one bounded-but-undisclosed unknown.
- **Add rung 1: \$95.00 → +0.40% of book.** (Pre-staged as instruction 114. Rests by default.)
- **Add rung 2: \$91.00 → +0.40% of book.** (Instruction 115. Rests by default.)

- **Add rung 3: \$87.00 → +0.40% of book.** (Instruction 116. Rests by default.) Full sleeve reached at 1.80%.
- **Hard re-underwrite, not an automatic add: \$82.54** (the 52-week low). A break of the low means the market is pricing something we have not found. No mechanical buying below it.
- **Gate for full size (not price-based):** the Nov 3–7 release must quantify Global Atlantic general-account below-investment-grade / asset-based-finance marks quarter-over-quarter **and** credit fee-paying assets. If it does and marks are bounded, all resting rungs may be lifted to market. If the release is silent again, **cap the position at the starter permanently** — a thesis whose only mechanism is undisclosable does not earn size.
- **Trim: \$120.77** (the convertible's initial conversion price). Above it the maximum-ratio dilution mechanically eases; take one-third off into that strength.
- **Exit: any new preferred or ultra-long subordinated note issue at a coupon ≥150bp above the prior comparable deal.** That is the tell that the fee annuity is being bought with dilutive capital. Exit regardless of price.
- **Exit: clean print, no re-rating.** If the release is clean and the stock cannot hold \$100 within five sessions after it, flatten.
- **Catalyst dates: 2026-10-26** (internal review pack / staging sweep — verify date on the annotation); **~2026-10-06** (expected “to announce” press release, KKR's own pattern is ~4 weeks ahead); **2026-11-03 to 2026-11-07** (Q3'26 release window — the pack's 2026-11-05 is yfinance-derived and **UNCONFIRMED**; a secondary calendar names Nov 3; Q3'25 printed Nov 7); **2028-03-01** (mandatory conversion, maximum 0.4140 ratio engaged at today's price).
- **Print proximity:** ~37 trading days. The 5-day print-decisive trigger does **not** fire. No pre-print reconstruction is mandated.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 100.0 (deck-provisional: post-print stop: clean release but cannot hold \$100 within five sessions means the mechanism is dead,)
- filing watch: 8-K until 2027-03-10 (deck-provisional: Q3'26 earnings release furnished as an 8-K exhibit in the Nov 3-7 window; must quantify Global Atlanti)
- dated pack KKR-REVIEW|2026-10-26: STAGING-SWEEP 2026-08-05 (bands-rest-by-default doctrine). instr 114/115/116 (53@95, 55@91, 57@87). Print est late-Oct - VERIFY date on anno
- dated pack KKR|2026-10-06: KKR: expected company 'to announce' press release naming the Q3 date (KKR pattern is ~4 weeks ahead) (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack KKR|2026-10-26: KKR: internal KKR-REVIEW dated pack / staging sweep; verify date on the annotation (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack KKR|2026-11-03: KKR: earliest edge of the Q3'26 print window (secondary calendar names Nov 3) (date confirmed=False)

- dated pack KKR|2026-11-05: KKR: pack's yfinance-derived Q3'26 print date (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack KKR|2026-11-07: KKR: latest edge of the print window (Q3'25 printed Nov 7) (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack KKR|2028-03-01: KKR: Series D mandatory conversion at the maximum 0.4140 ratio, ~21.4mm shares, ~2.3% dilution (date confirmed=True)

What remains unverified

1. **Global Atlantic general-account credit marks (below-investment-grade / asset-based-finance), direction and magnitude quarter-over-quarter.** Not drainable now — gated to the Nov 3–7 release. *Estimate:* insurance operating earnings are \$288mm/quarter, ~19% of ~\$1.5bn quarterly total operating earnings, which caps the earnings channel; on comparable alt-owned annuity general accounts, below-investment-grade allocations run roughly 5–8% of invested assets and annual credit losses roughly 150–300bp of that slice, implying ~\$150–450mm/year pre-tax. Probability it lands “bounded” (under ~\$300mm/yr, no reserve build): **0.60**.
2. **Options chain: chain-level midpoint implied volatility, implied-volatility percentile, and real quotes at the November \$105/\$110 strikes.** Drainable now (IBKR). Must use chain-level midpoint, never the aggregate underlying volatility feed — the TSSI 71-vs-101 lesson. *Estimate pending pull:* 30–38% implied on a \$94bn financial into a print.
3. **Q3'26 consensus fee-related earnings and adjusted net income, with the estimate range.** Drainable now (consensus connector). Only the Q2 actual-vs-estimate (\$1.63 vs \$1.43) was obtained; the forward anchor was never pulled by either bench.
4. **Confirmed Q3'26 print date.** Not drainable now — needs a company press release (pattern: ~4 weeks ahead, so ~Oct 6). *Estimate:* Nov 3–7 window, **p = 0.85**; the pack's 2026-11-05 is yfinance-derived.
5. **Tax Receivable Agreement liability and remaining exchangeable units.** Drainable now (10-Q XBRL, kkr-20260630.htm). Blue flagged this detector as unchecked; red omitted it entirely.
6. **Whether KKR owns 100% of Global Atlantic (post-January-2024 minority buy-in).** Drainable now (10-Q). Blue asserted 100% *from memory, not fetched* — and the whole “all general-account marks hit common” framing depends on it. *Estimate:* p = 0.85 that 100% is correct.
7. **Proceeds and gain from the USI sale actually attributable to KKR & Co. Inc.** Not drainable now — no filed number exists; the 8-K is Item 7.01 with no economics. *Estimate:* ~\$2bn of adjusted net income per the company statement reported in press, **p = 0.65** that the filed figure lands within ±20% of that.
8. **Q3 K-Series / K-FIT repurchase requests and net flows.** Not drainable now — gated to Q3 disclosure. *Estimate:* **1.5–3.0% of shares requested, met in full**, extrapolating the 6.3%→1.65% trend, **p = 0.60**.

9. **Our tradeable liquidity: KKR average daily volume.** Drainable now (IBKR). *Estimate: 4–6mm shares/day, ~\$450–600mm notional*, from mega-cap alt-manager comps; at that level a 1.8%-of-book sleeve is a small fraction of one day and reflexivity from our own size is not a live risk.

PRIZE TABLE + VOL READ

Required: item 1 (Global Atlantic marks) is genuinely time-gated and private until the November print. Anchored on today's \$101.73 and adjusted from there, per anchor-and-adjust.

Scenario (decided at the Nov 3–7 print)	p	Price	p × Price
Marks quantified and bounded; credit fee-paying assets growing; flows stay normalized — the discount's only mechanism dies	0.45	\$115	\$51.75
Partial disclosure again: no quarter-over-quarter general-account breakout. Opacity persists, nothing re-rates	0.30	\$102	\$30.60
Marks disclosed and adverse: reserve build or visible below-investment-grade damage; insurance earnings quality questioned	0.20	\$84	\$16.80
Adverse marks plus renewed retail redemption proration	0.05	\$68	\$3.40

EV = \$102.55 vs spot \$101.73 → +0.8%. That is the honest answer and it is why this is a starter, not a position. The table's payoff is not in the expected value; it is in the asymmetry *below* spot, which is exactly what the resting \$95/\$91/\$87 rungs harvest.

Table dispersion: $\sigma_{\text{table}} = \$14.08 = 13.84\%$ of spot over the ~70 days to a late-November expiry ($T = 0.192y$) → an implied annualized **31.6%**.

Bimodality: the table is fork-dated on a single event with a 45/25 up/down split and a 30% “nothing happens” middle. The two tails are a +13% gap and a –17%/–33% gap. A call-only expression captures one fork of three and pays nothing in the 30% middle — that matters below.

Expression math, priced off the table itself: - $C_{\text{ours}}(K = \$105, \text{Nov}) = \sum p_i \times \max(S_i - K, 0) = 0.45 \times \$10 = \mathbf{\$4.50}$ (undiscounted). - $C_{\text{ours}}(K = \$110, \text{Nov}) = 0.45 \times \$5 = \mathbf{\$2.25}$.

Decision rule, and its output: buy the November \$105 calls only if the real chain midpoint is **below \$4.50** and chain-level midpoint implied volatility is **below ~31.6%** (the table's own dispersion). If chain implied volatility prints **above ~34%**, the volatility risk premium is positive enough that the gated add routes to cash-secured puts at the \$91 rung instead of long calls. **We do not have the chain** (unverified item 2) — no options chain was supplied in the pack, so implied-vs-realized, the implied-volatility percentile and the volatility risk premium (implied minus realized) are all uncomputable today. **Therefore the instrument recommendation is the output of arithmetic we can complete, not arithmetic we can't: COMMON STOCK for the starter and for all three rungs.** Options are explicitly *not* recommended in this deck; re-run the two lines above against real quotes before any option is written, and never off the aggregate underlying volatility feed.

Tax overlay: the loss branch must land in the intended tax year. Common stock satisfies this trivially — a loss is harvestable whenever we choose (mind the 30-day wash-sale window around the rungs, which are only 4–9% apart and will otherwise trip it). Had we gone to options: a **November 2026 expiry** puts the loss branch inside the 2026 tax year and is **permitted** in a harvest year; any **January 2027 or later expiry defers the loss past December 31 and is EXCLUDED** during a harvest year unless the edge numerically dominates — and at EV +0.8%, it does not. That alone disqualifies LEAP expressions here.

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